



Bappa.org Spotlights Today's Top 5 Ganesh Stories: Real People, Green Ideas, and Global Celebrations

Mumbai, 17th September 2026: Under the Maharashtra Cultural Affairs Department's #GharoGhariBappa initiative, **Bappa.org**, the state's digital archive portal, announced its daily Top 5 Ganeshotsav stories. The initiative records festival memories across homes, local sarvajanik mandals, historic temples, and overseas Indian communities.

Every citizen, mandal, or temple trust that uploads their photo and story receives an official **Digital Cultural Preserver Certificate** from the Government of Maharashtra, with standout entries selected for daily state media spotlights and public features.

Today's Top 5 Featured Stories on Bappa.org

1. Guhagar's Ancestral Gauri-Ganpati Tradition - Welcoming Nature's Grace through the Fields

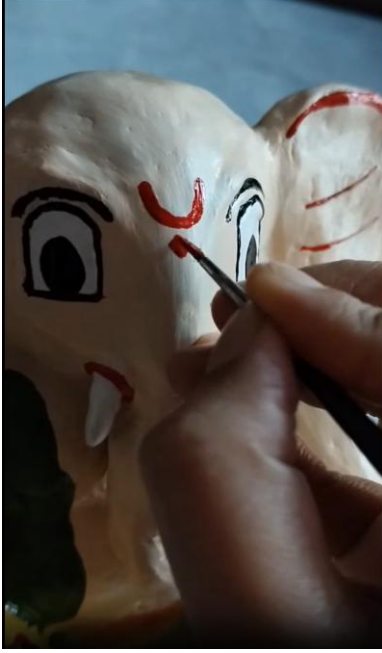
From the coastal heartland of Guhagar in the Konkan belt, village women carry the traditional brass thalis bearing the sacred Gauri idol, ceremonial coconuts, and wild *terda* stalks directly on their heads. Walking together through lush green paddy fields and village canals, this centuries-old coastal ritual connects festive worship with agrarian nature, feminine power, and ancestral reverence.





2. Nikita J. Panchal - Hand-Sculpted Clay Idol Made from Scratch at Home

Skipping store-bought plaster-of-Paris idols and synthetic paints, Nikita made and hand-painted her own clay Murti directly from raw clay at home, keeping the traditional art of clay crafting alive without harming the environment.



3. Sanjay Mangalaram - First-Ever Home Welcoming in Pune

After years of traveling to their ancestral village for the festival, the family welcomed Bappa into their own newly bought home in Pune for the very first time. The highlight: their two young daughters led the daily prayers and aartis, passing the tradition down to the next generation.





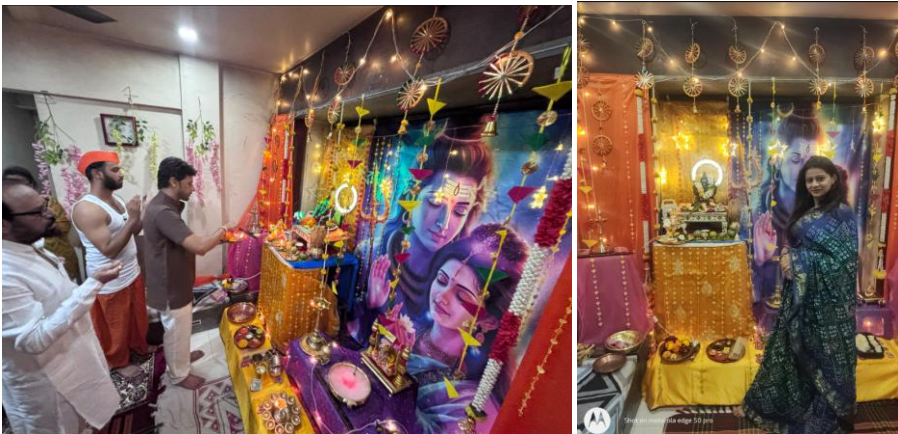
4. Ishwar Manohar Borse - Students Celebrate Hometown Traditions in Vietnam

Miles away from Maharashtra, Indian students studying in Vietnam came together to celebrate Ganesh Chaturthi. Despite having limited access to festive items abroad, they handcrafted fresh modaks and welcomed friends, keeping their roots alive overseas.



5. Parag Narayan Sheth Gujarathi - 65-Year Family Legacy & Terrace Reforestation Turning Visarjan Soil into 30+ Trees

The Gujarathi family has celebrated Ganeshotsav together for 65 years. For the past six years, they have used clay idols and done the visarjan at home on their terrace. They use the immersion soil to grow saplings, nurture them past five feet, and then plant them along local riverbanks and hills. They have grown more than 30 trees this way.





How to Share Your Story & Get Recognized

The Cultural Affairs Department welcomes every home, housing society, Sarvajanik mandal, and temple trust to join Maharashtra's official cultural archive.

1. Go to **Bappa.org** on your phone or computer.
2. Upload a photo of your Bappa and write a short note about your setup, tradition, or community work.
3. Receive your official **Government Certificate of Cultural Preservation** upon successful submission
4. **Get Featured:** Standout submissions featuring unique traditions, eco-friendly crafts, or public service will be recognized in the daily Top 5 state spotlights and shared across government media platforms.

#GharoGhariBappa | Submit your story at Bappa.org today.